Writing: Image: the real me and the picture of me

Day 2 · Writing

What to do: Discuss first (exercise 1), then write in the copybook at home or in class.

Murphy today
Murphy red, Unit 20 (page 51): **20.3, 20.4** at home. Do the grammar file first.

1 Warm-up: talk before you write (5 minutes, in pairs)

1. Do you post photos online? Which ones and why?
2. What kind of image do you want to show to other people?
3. Is the picture on social media different from real life? How?
4. Have you ever felt proud of a photo you posted? What happened?
5. Have you ever felt bad because of somebody else's photos?
6. What did you do last weekend that you did not photograph?
7. Which is more important: to be real or to look good? Why?
8. What advice would you give to a younger student about social media?

Choose one topic and tell it to your partner. The partner asks one more question for each of the first 3 answers.

2 Useful words

image · real life · show off · proud of · focus on · so far · last week · yesterday · I have never...

Unit 10 words: image · proud · focus · essential · benefit · trouble · separate · rest

3 The plan: 4 short paragraphs, 120–150 words

1 · Introduction	What is the topic? What do you think about showing off online? (present simple)
2 · Body 1	Your experience so far: have you ever...? (present perfect) + one detail in the past simple.
3 · Body 2	What happened last week or yesterday? (past simple)
4 · Conclusion	Your advice or opinion.

Model and your task

Day 2 · Writing

What to do: In the model: present perfect for the experience, past simple for the details with time words.

Real Life or a Good Picture?

Many people show a perfect image of their life online. I think this is understandable, but it can also cause trouble.

I have posted about fifty photos so far. I have always chosen the best ones, and I have never posted a picture of a bad day. Last summer I took a photo of a beautiful beach, but I did not show the long way to get there, or my tired face.

Yesterday I saw a post of a friend with a lot of smiling photos. Later she told me she had a terrible week. I was surprised, because her pictures looked so happy.

Now I focus more on real life. A photo shows one second, but the rest of the day is also important. My advice: put your phone away sometimes and just enjoy the day.

A Choose ONE: image and real life

Write 120–150 words. Follow the plan. Use the present perfect at least 4 times, the past simple at least 4 times with a finished time, and 4 words from Unit 10.

B Or: a message to a younger friend

Write 100–120 words. *Dear ..., I have been thinking about your photos. I think... Last week I... My advice is...*

Check before you finish

4 paragraphs · present perfect for experience · past simple with last week / yesterday / ago · 4 Unit 10 words · capital letters and full stops